Grade 9 English Language: A community library that travels

English Language · Grade 9 · 40 marks · 90 minutes

Educator marking memo

Suggested answers and marking points. Accept equivalent correct responses appropriate to the grade.

Assessment

Read the stimulus and each question carefully.

> *Every Thursday, a small van parks beside Mhlabeni Community Hall. It carries books, newspapers and a few tablets loaded with reading activities. The service began when residents noticed that many children travelled far to reach the nearest library. Volunteer Naledi records which books are borrowed so the team can bring popular titles next time. The tablets work offline, so learners can use them even when the mobile signal is weak. Adults may also borrow newspapers and ask volunteers for help with online forms. The service cannot visit every street each week, so residents suggest stops at a monthly meeting. Naledi says the van is useful because people help shape its route.*

1.1 (6 marks) Name three services the van offers and state where it stops each Thursday.

- Names the book or newspaper lending service. (1 mark)
- Names the tablet reading activities. (1 mark)
- Names help with online forms. (1 mark)
- States that the van stops beside Mhlabeni Community Hall. (1 mark)
- States that the van stops there every Thursday. (1 mark)
- Presents the information clearly and accurately using passage details. (1 mark)

1.2 (7 marks) Explain why the service records borrowed books and uses offline tablets.

- Links borrowing records to identifying popular titles. (1 mark)
- Links popular titles to future stock choices. (1 mark)
- States offline tablets work without a mobile signal. (1 mark)
- Explains how this helps learners in a weak-signal area. (1 mark)
- Uses evidence from the passage. (1 mark)
- Keeps the two reasons distinct. (1 mark)
- Writes a logical explanation. (1 mark)

1.3 (8 marks) What does Naledi mean when she says residents help shape the route?

- Identifies the monthly meeting as a way to give suggestions. (1 mark)
- Explains that suggestions influence where the van stops. (1 mark)
- Connects route choice to community needs. (1 mark)
- Uses the passage rather than an unsupported assumption. (1 mark)
- Distinguishes consultation from guaranteed weekly service. (1 mark)
- Gives one relevant example from the text. (1 mark)
- Writes in own words. (1 mark)
- Makes the meaning clear. (1 mark)

1.4 (9 marks) Rewrite 'The tablets work offline, so learners can use them even when the mobile signal is weak' as two sentences without changing its meaning. Preserve both facts and their cause-and-effect link; check grammar, capitals and punctuation, and do not add a new claim.

- Produces two complete sentences. (1 mark)
- Keeps the fact that tablets work offline. (1 mark)
- Keeps the fact that learners can use them. (1 mark)
- Keeps the weak-signal condition. (1 mark)
- Uses an appropriate linking or explanatory phrase. (1 mark)
- Uses capitals correctly. (1 mark)
- Uses end punctuation correctly. (1 mark)
- Maintains grammatical agreement. (1 mark)
- Does not add a new claim. (1 mark)

1.5 (10 marks) In a short paragraph, evaluate one strength and one limitation of the travelling library service.

- Identifies a supported strength. (1 mark)
- Explains who benefits from it. (1 mark)
- Identifies the limitation that it cannot visit every street weekly. (1 mark)
- Explains the effect of the limitation. (1 mark)
- Uses one piece of textual evidence for the strength. (1 mark)
- Uses one piece of textual evidence for the limitation. (1 mark)
- Makes a balanced judgment. (1 mark)
- Uses a coherent paragraph structure. (1 mark)
- Uses appropriate vocabulary. (1 mark)
- Maintains a clear conclusion. (1 mark)

Marking checks

Confirm section totals equal the stated total. Apply the grade-appropriate memo style in the Grade Profile and moderate open-ended answers before use.

Source basis: DBE CAPS English · senior_grade_7_9. See the grade receipt for the official PDF URL and SHA-256.
DRAFT — Qualified educator review required before classroom use.